

THE GEOMETRY OF FEAR

By

Susan Taylor

The tires crunched on the gravel of the long, winding drive, the sound echoing unnaturally in the still night. Inside the old Ford, Elias gripped the steering wheel, his knuckles white. Beside him, Sarah stared out at the looming silhouette of Blackwood Manor, its darkened windows like vacant eyes staring back. The full moon, a spectral orb hanging high above, cast long, distorted shadows that danced with the swaying branches of the ancient trees lining the road.

“Are you sure about this, Elias?” Sarah asked, her voice barely a whisper. A shiver traced its way down her spine despite the late summer heat.

Elias sighed, his gaze fixed on the house. “We’ve been over this, Sarah. This is the only lead we have on your grandfather’s disappearance. Professor Armitage believed his final research was conducted here, at Blackwood Manor.”

Blackwood Manor. Even the name felt heavy, laden with a sense of forgotten dread. Locals in the nearby village of Oakhaven spoke of it in hushed tones, tales of tragedy and strange occurrences clinging to its decaying façade like the ivy that crawled up its stone walls. No one had lived in the manor

for decades, not since the infamous Blackwood family had vanished without a trace.

As they drew closer, the details of the house became sharper. It was a grand, colonial-style building, its architecture imposing even in its state of disrepair. Two chimneys stood like silent sentinels against the moonlit sky. Most of the windows were dark, but a few on the ground floor glowed with a faint, yellowish light, an unsettling invitation in the darkness.

But it wasn't the house itself that sent a knot of unease tightening in Sarah's stomach. It was what floated above it.

Scattered across the starry expanse, like dark blemishes on the canvas of the night, were several geometric cubes. They were perfectly formed, their edges sharp and defined, yet they seemed to defy gravity, hanging silently in the air. There was no visible means of their suspension, no wires or supports. They simply were, an impossible geometry against the backdrop of the natural world.

“What are those things?” Sarah breathed, pointing a trembling finger.

Elias followed her gaze, his brow furrowed. “I… I don’t know. Professor Armitage mentioned unusual atmospheric phenomena around Blackwood, but nothing like this.”

A flock of birds, dark silhouettes against the moon, suddenly erupted from the trees near the manor, their frantic cries piercing the silence. They circled erratically before disappearing

into the darkness, leaving behind an even more profound stillness.

Elias parked the car at the end of the drive, the headlights cutting through the darkness before he switched off the engine. The sudden silence was almost deafening, broken only by the distant hoot of an owl.

“Let’s stick together,” Elias said, his hand instinctively reaching for the flashlight in the glove compartment.

They stepped out of the car, the gravel crunching under their feet. The air was heavy and still, carrying a faint scent of damp earth and something else… something metallic and faintly sweet, like old blood.

As they walked towards the manor, the glowing windows seemed to grow brighter, their light casting an eerie luminescence on the overgrown lawn. Sarah felt a prickling sensation on the back of her neck, the feeling of being watched by unseen eyes.

The front door, a massive oak affair, was slightly ajar. A sliver of yellow light spilled out into the darkness. Elias hesitated for a moment before pushing it open further. The hinges groaned in protest, the sound echoing through the silent house.

The air inside was thick with the smell of dust and decay. The entrance hall was grand but neglected, cobwebs draping the ornate chandelier and shadows clinging to the high ceilings. The

faint light from the nearby room cast long, dancing figures on the walls.

“Hello?” Elias called out, his voice echoing eerily. Only silence answered.

They moved cautiously into the room from which the light emanated. It was a study, lined with bookshelves filled with decaying tomes. A single oil lamp flickered on a large mahogany desk, casting a warm but unsettling glow. Papers were scattered across the desk, covered in strange symbols and diagrams that Sarah didn’t recognize.

“This must be Professor Armitage’s work,” Elias murmured, picking up one of the pages. His eyes scanned the intricate drawings. “He was obsessed with ancient geometries and their connection to… other dimensions?”

As Elias examined the papers, Sarah’s gaze was drawn to the window. Outside, the floating cubes seemed closer now, their dark surfaces reflecting the moonlight like polished obsidian. One of them shifted slightly, rotating silently in the air.

A sudden creak from the floorboards above made them both jump. They exchanged nervous glances.

“We’re not alone,” Sarah whispered.

Elias nodded, gripping the flashlight tighter. “Let’s check it out.”

They ascended the creaking staircase, the shadows seeming to deepen with each step. The air grew colder, and the metallic

scent was stronger here. On the landing, a long hallway stretched before them, lined with closed doors.

As they moved down the hallway, a low humming sound filled the air, a resonant vibration that seemed to emanate from the very walls. The glowing windows downstairs flickered erratically.

Suddenly, one of the doors at the end of the hallway slowly creaked open. A gust of icy air rushed out, carrying with it a scent that made Sarah gag – the unmistakable stench of decay.

Elias raised the flashlight, its beam cutting through the darkness of the open room. Sarah gasped. The room was empty, but the air within shimmered with an unnatural energy. In the center of the room, etched into the wooden floorboards, was a large, geometric symbol, its lines glowing faintly in the darkness. It was a cube, depicted in intricate detail, but somehow… wrong. Distorted.

The humming intensified, and the floating cubes outside began to glow with a soft, internal light, mirroring the symbol on the floor. The walls of the room seemed to pulse, and the air grew heavy, pressing down on them.

A low growl echoed from the shadows in the corner of the room, a sound that was not animalistic, but something colder, something more… dimensional.

Fear, primal and absolute, gripped Sarah's heart. This was not just a haunted house. This was something far more ancient, far more alien.

One of the floating cubes outside the window began to descend slowly, silently, towards the house. Its shadow fell over the room, plunging it into an even deeper darkness.

Elias grabbed Sarah's arm, his face pale with terror. "We have to get out of here!"

They turned to flee, but the door slammed shut with a deafening bang. The humming reached a fever pitch, and the geometric symbol on the floor blazed with an eerie light.

From the shadows, shapes began to coalesce, shifting and reforming, their forms echoing the impossible geometry of the cubes above. They were not human, not animal, but something in between, their bodies contorting into angles that defied the natural world.

Sarah screamed, her mind reeling at the sight of such unholy forms. The air crackled with an unseen energy, and the metallic scent became overpowering.

The geometry of the house itself seemed to warp and twist, the walls groaning, the floorboards vibrating. The floating cubes outside pressed closer, their silent descent a promise of something terrible.

They were trapped, caught in a nexus of impossible dimensions, surrounded by entities that existed beyond human

comprehension. Blackwood Manor was not just a place of death; it was a gateway, a point where the geometry of our world intersected with something else, something ancient and hungry.

As the inhuman shapes lunged, their forms contorting into ever more bizarre angles, Sarah closed her eyes, the final, terrifying realization dawning in her mind. Her grandfather hadn't just disappeared. He had become a part of the geometry of fear, forever bound to the haunted angles of Blackwood Manor and the silent, floating cubes that ruled the night.